arc BA ($\overset{\frown}{BA}$) is the larger one. Each of the parts of the pizza represents the circular sectors. Here A_1 is the minor sector and A_2 is the major sector.

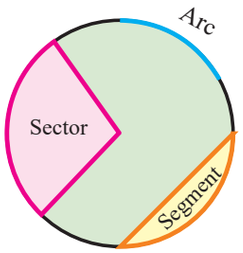
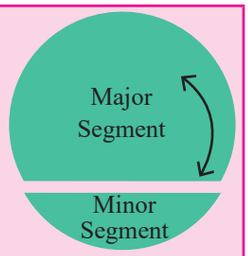


Fig. 2.5

- A part of the circumference of a circle is called a circular arc.
- The plane surface that is enclosed between two radii and the circular arc of a circle is called a sector.
- Each part of a circle which is divided by a chord is called a segment.

Note

The part which has a smaller arc is called as the **'minor segment'** and the part which has a larger arc is called as the **'major segment'.**



Think

The given circular figure is divided into six equal parts. Can we call the equal parts as sectors? Why?


Fig. 2.6

Central Angle

The angle formed by a sector of a circle at its centre is called the central angle. The vertex of the central angle of the sector is the centre of the circle. The two arms of it are the radii. In the Fig. 2.7, the shaded sector has the central angle, $\angle AOB = \theta^\circ$ (read as theta) and its two arms OA and OB are the radii of the circle.

The central angle of a circle is 360°. If a circle is divided into 'n' equal sectors, the central angle of each of the sectors is $\theta^\circ = \frac{360^\circ}{n}$.

For example, the central angle of a semicircle $= \frac{360^\circ}{2} = 180^\circ$ and the central angle of a quadrant of a circle $= \frac{360^\circ}{4} = 90^\circ$.

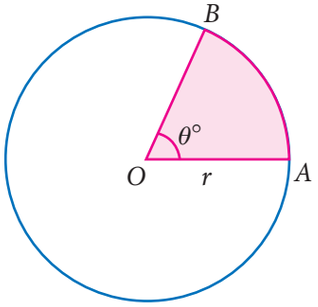
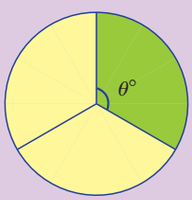
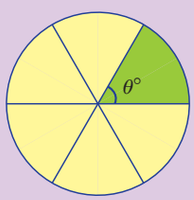
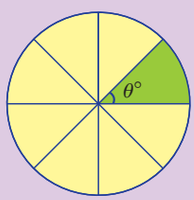
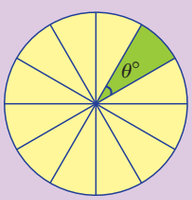


Fig. 2.7

Try these

Fill the central angle of the shaded sector (each circle is divided into equal sectors)

Sectors				
Central angle $\theta^\circ \left(= \frac{360^\circ}{n}\right)$	$\theta^\circ = 120^\circ$			

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